

GOV-01: Clinical Policy Governance

Bellcourt internal standard | Owner: Chief Medical Officer | Last reviewed 2025-06-30

1. Hierarchy of authority

When sources conflict, reviewers apply them in this order:

- 1 Federal and state law and regulation applicable to the product.
- 2 The client's plan document (SPD) or delegation agreement, including Medicare coverage rules for MA members.
- 3 Bellcourt medical policies approved by the Clinical Policy Committee, in the version effective on the date of service.
- 4 Operational memos, job aids and training materials. These explain process and **cannot change clinical criteria**. A memo that conflicts with an approved medical policy is void to the extent of the conflict.

2. Version control

Medical policies are versioned. Reviewers must apply the version effective on the date of service, not the date of the request or the date of review. Retired versions remain in the UM Library for reference.

3. Criteria screens in PACE

PACE displays criteria 'screens' for common services. Screens are convenience aids maintained by the Systems team; the policy PDF in the UM Library is the authoritative text.